

GERI SKENDERI

MEMBER OF TECHNICAL STAFF

HASH

Berlin, Germany

g@hash.ai · geriskenderi.github.io

01 RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Member of Technical Staff

Sep 2026 - Present

HASH · Berlin, Germany

Founding researcher of the HASH AI lab.

Lead of graph representation learning.

Postdoctoral researcher

Feb 2024 - Sep 2026

Bocconi Institute for Data Science and Analytics · Milan, Italy

Machine Learning & Statistical Physics Group; supervisor: Carlo Lucibello.

Physics-inspired benchmarks and understanding of Graph Neural Networks for constraint satisfaction problems.

Affiliated guest researcher

Apr 2024 - Sep 2026

AIRC Institute of Molecular Oncology Foundation (IFOM) · Milan, Italy

Artificial Intelligence & Systems Biology Lab; supervisor: Francesca Buffa.

AI for clinical genomics.

Visiting scholar (PhD)

Aug - Dec 2023

Michigan State University · East Lansing, Michigan, USA

Data Science and Engineering Lab; supervisor: Jiliang Tang.

Graph representation learning.

02 EDUCATION

PhD in Computer Science

Oct 2020 - Sep 2024

University of Verona, Italy · Supervisor: Marco Cristani

Thesis: *Graphs, Geometry, and Learning Representations: Navigating the Non-Euclidean Landscape in Computer Vision and Beyond*. Defended 13 September 2024.

MSc in Computational Data Science

Oct 2018 - Jul 2020

Free University of Bozen-Bolzano, Italy

Data Analytics curriculum · 110/110 *cum laude*

BSc in Computer Science and Engineering

Oct 2014 - Sep 2017

Free University of Bozen-Bolzano, Italy · Computer Science curriculum

Summer schools

London Geometry and Machine Learning, Imperial College London

Jul 2025

Statistical Physics of Deep Learning II, Lake Como School of Advanced Studies

Jun 2024

03 ACADEMIC SERVICE & RECOGNITION

Organising committee, LOGML Summer School

2026

Imperial College London · Sponsorships & Grants Team

Sponsor liaison, funding coordination, grant writing and pitch presentations. More than £30000 raised.

Peer review

Conferences: NeurIPS, AAAI, CVPR, ICCV, ECCV, WSDM.

Journals: TMLR; IEEE TPAMI; IEEE TNNLS; Pattern Recognition; Pattern Recognition Letters.

CVPR Outstanding Reviewer

2025

04 SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- 2026 **Hyperbolic Graph Neural Networks Under the Microscope: The Role of Geometry-Task Alignment**
Naddeo, D., Linkerhägner, J., Toschi, N., **Skenderi, G.**[◇], & Lachi, V.
[Neural Information Processing Systems \(NeurIPS\) 2026](#)
- 2026 **A Geometric Perspective on the Difficulties of Learning GNN-based SAT Solvers**
Skenderi, G.
[ICLR Workshop on Geometry-grounded Representation Learning and Generative Modeling \(PMLR\).](#)
- 2026 **Benchmarking Graph Neural Networks in Solving Hard Constraint Satisfaction Problems**
Skenderi, G., Buffoni, L., D'Amico, F., Machado, D., Marino, R., Negri, M., Ricci-Tersenghi, F., Lucibello, C., & Angelini, M. C.
[Preprint · \[arXiv:2602.18419\]\(#\)](#)
- 2025 **Graph-level Representation Learning with Joint-Embedding Predictive Architectures**
Skenderi, G., Li, H., Tang, J., & Cristani, M.
[Transactions on Machine Learning Research \(TMLR\).](#)
- 2025 **Disentangled Latent Spaces Facilitate Data-Driven Auxiliary Learning**
Skenderi, G., Capogrosso, L., Toaiari, A., Denitto, M., Fummi, F., & Melzi, S.
[23rd International Conference on Image Analysis and Processing \(ICIAP\).](#)
- 2024 **Sub-graph Based Diffusion Model for Link Prediction**
Li, H., Jin, W., **Skenderi, G.**, Shomer, H., Tang, W., Fan, W., & Tang, J.
[Third Learning on Graphs Conference \(LoG\), PMLR.](#)
- 2024 **Well Googled is Half Done: Multimodal Forecasting of New Fashion Product Sales with Image-based Google Trends**
Skenderi, G., Joppi, C., Denitto, M., & Cristani, M.
[Wiley Journal of Forecasting.](#)
- 2023 **Leveraging commonsense for object localisation in partial scenes**
Giuliari, F., **Skenderi, G.**, Cristani, M., Del Bue, A., & Wang, Y.
[IEEE Transactions on Pattern Analysis and Machine Intelligence \(TPAMI\).](#)
- 2023 **Towards Deep Learning-based Occupancy Detection Via WiFi Sensing in Unconstrained Environments**
Turetta, C., **Skenderi, G.**, Capogrosso, L., Demrozi, F., Kindt, P. H., Masrur, A., ... & Pravadelli, G.
[Design, Automation & Test in Europe Conference & Exhibition \(DATE\).](#)
- 2022 **Spatial commonsense graph for object localisation in partial scenes**
Giuliari, F., **Skenderi, G.**, Cristani, M., Wang, Y., & Del Bue, A.
[IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition \(CVPR\).](#)
- 2022 **POP: Mining POtential Performance of new fashion products via webly cross-modal query expansion**
Joppi, C.^{*}, **Skenderi, G.**^{*}, & Cristani, M.
[European Conference on Computer Vision \(ECCV\).](#)
- 2022 **Pose forecasting in industrial human-robot collaboration**
Sampieri, A., di Melendugno, G. M. D. A., Avogaro, A., Cunico, F., Setti, F., **Skenderi, G.**, Cristani, M., & Galasso, F.
[European Conference on Computer Vision \(ECCV\).](#)
- 2022 **MovingFashion: a Benchmark for the Video-to-Shop Challenge**
Godi, M.^{*}, Joppi, C.^{*}, **Skenderi, G.**^{*}, & Cristani, M.
[IEEE/CVF Winter Conference on Applications of Computer Vision \(WACV\).](#)

^{*} Equal contribution.

[◇] Main theory contribution.

05 TALKS

- On the Hardness of Learning GNN-based SAT Solvers: The Role of Graph Ricci Curvature** Sep 2025
Contributed talk, Young Applied Mathematicians Conference (5th edition), Padova, Italy.
- Graph-level Representation Learning with Joint-Embedding Predictive Architectures** May 2025
TMLR-track oral, Graph Signal Processing Workshop, Mila, Montréal, Canada. · [Recording](#)
- Graphs, Geometry, and Learning Representations: Navigating the Non-Euclidean Landscape in Computer Vision and Beyond** Sep 2024
Invited seminar, Machine Learning Genoa Center (MALGA), University of Genova, Italy.
- Data-Driven Auxiliary Learning Through Latent Space Disentanglement** Sep 2024
Contributed talk, ROccella Conference on INference and AI (ROCKIN' AI), Roccella Jonica, Italy.
- A Journey into Variational Inference for Deep Generative Modeling: From Variational Autoencoders to Denoising Diffusion Probabilistic Models** Jul 2023
Graduate seminar, Department of Computer Science, University of Verona, Italy. · [Recording](#)
- The Transformer Revolution: Attention-based Machine Learning** Nov 2021
Contributed talk, South Tyrol Free Software Conference, remote. · [Recording](#)

06 TEACHING

- Bocconi University** · Master's courses AY 2025–26
Guest lecturer: “Graph Neural Networks with Applications” for *Deep Learning and Reinforcement Learning and Artificial Intelligence – Module 2*.
Teaching assistant: *Computer Vision and Image Processing*.
- Bocconi University** · PhD course AY 2023–24
Guest lecturer: “Principles of Equivariant and Invariant Learning on Graphs”, *Modern Applied Machine Learning*.
- University of Verona** · Master's courses AY 2020–22
Teaching assistant: *Machine Learning & Artificial Intelligence* (AY 2020–21 and 2021–22); *Fundamentals of Machine Learning and Deep Learning* (AY 2020–21).

07 MENTORING

- Luigi Capogrosso** · PhD student, University of Verona Nov 2021 – Nov 2024
Representation learning in resource-constrained scenarios.
Co-authored: ICIAP 2025; DATE 2023.
- Andrea Toiari** · PhD student, University of Verona Nov 2022 – Nov 2024
Latent disentanglement for auxiliary task generation. Co-authored: ICIAP 2025.
- Andrea Avogaro** · PhD student, University of Verona Jan 2022 – Jun 2024
Human pose forecasting with spatiotemporal graph models. Co-authored: ECCV 2022.
- Hang Li** · PhD student, Michigan State University Sep – Dec 2023
Self-supervised learning and diffusion on graphs. Co-authored: LoG 2024, TMLR.
- Uzair Hassan Khan** · MSc student, University of Verona Mar – Jul 2023
Thesis: *Unsupervised disentanglement of latent embeddings: A case study on human trajectory prediction*.

08 TECHNICAL SKILLS & LANGUAGES

- Tools:** Python, PyTorch, PyTorch Geometric, NumPy, scikit-learn, Julia, Git, HPC clusters, $\text{\LaTeX}$.
Methods: Geometric Deep Learning, Graph Neural Networks, Self-Supervised Learning, Probability, Analysis.
Languages: Albanian (native), English (fluent), Italian (fluent).